

Case Study: The Phishing Scam

Phishing is a type of cybercrime where a scammer sends a fake email, SMS, or message that looks like it comes from a trusted company. Their goal is to trick you into clicking a link and entering your private data. This method is common among attackers.

How it typically happens:

1. **The Fake Message:** A student receives an email that looks just like an official notice from their bank. The subject line usually contains something alarming, like Urgent: Your Account will be Blocked in 24 Hours. Sometimes the email includes logos and formatting to seem more authentic.
2. **The Hook:** The email tells the student they must "verify their identity" immediately to keep their account active.
3. **The Fake Website:** When the student clicks the button, it opens a website that looks identical to the real bank's login page.
4. **The Theft:** The student enters their username and password into the fake site. The scammer instantly sees this information and uses it to access the real bank account to steal money or change the password.
5. **Who is usually targeted:** Students and office workers are frequently targeted because they use many online services.
6. **What the consequences are:** The most serious consequence is identity theft. Once a scammer has your login details, they can steal your money, access your private photos, or commit other crimes using your name.